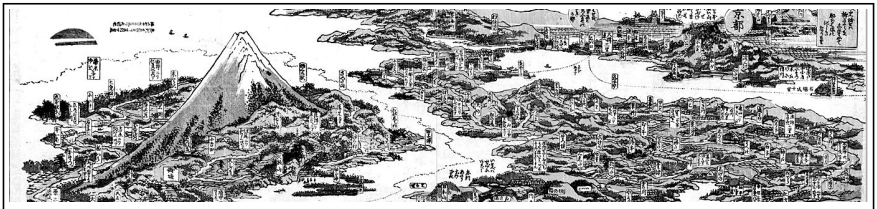
MORNING EDITION TORONTO

The Long View

16° · 6° MILD & CLOUDY

Printed once a day. Finished by breakfast.

TUESDAY, NOVEMBER 10, 2026 NO. 1 20 PAGES · 5 SHEETS · $1.00



Mount Fuji and the old road from Edo to Kyoto, drawn by Katsushika Hokusai around 1818. The back page starts down that road today.

Three AI Safety Week sessions fill your day at the Design Exchange, from 11:15 to 4:45. Paul Christiano's second Hinton Lecture streams at 6. It stays dry and mild, up to 16°. Rain is likely on Thursday. One thing is late: the PHLB18 reading response was due Monday.

TODAY · TUESDAY

11:15 Forecasting: Jobs and the Economy
Design Exchange, 234 Bay St · until 12:30

1:30 Post-AGI Civilization: What's the Destination? (David Duvenaud)
Design Exchange · until 3:00

3:15 Research & Ideas Gallery (posters)
Design Exchange · until 4:45

6:00 *Hinton Lectures, night 2: Paul Christiano on oversight*
Livestream · until 7:30 · you can rewind

TODAY	WED	THU	FRI	SAT
16° / 6°	11° / 5° 52%	9° / 3° 66% rain	6° / 1°	6° / 3°

INSIDE, IN ONE MINUTE

ESSAYS Damon Linker on Trump's new chief of staff. A Chinese analyst on startup money.

P. 6 Old rights cases in Indonesia; two new crossings in Cyprus.

TO DO

ACADEMICS

- [ ] PHLB18 reading response. It was due Monday. · Todoist
- [ ] Scaffolding Assignment 2 is still open from Nov 2. No. 3 is due Nov 23. · Todoist
- [ ] Click the link in the "Confirm Email: Canvas" email, if you haven't. · Quercus

TAISI

- [ ] Upload your receipts to HCB. Isabel asked everyone on Monday. · #taisi-team
- [ ] Shivam's cohort, Mon Nov 16: order the kosher meal too. · Todoist

MISC

- [ ] Pay off the credit card by Thursday. · Todoist
- [ ] No date yet: Health and Wellness visit, bike, co-op papers. · Todoist

FOR YOU

Your Desk

What needs you, and what TAISI talked about

NEEDS YOU

1. **One school task is late.** Todoist still shows the PHLB18 reading response, due Monday, and Scaffolding Assignment 2, due Nov 2. Tick them off if they are done. — Todoist
2. **Two courses close in six days.** BlueDot's free online governance course closes Sunday, Nov 15. CLR's reading course closes Monday, Nov 16. Both are online. — bluedot.org · longtermrisk.org
3. **Tell TAISI's leads about Nov 24.** Kairos now funds only student groups that have an organizer in its Pathfinder Fellowship. Applications close Tuesday, Nov 24. — kairos-project.org

THIS WEEK AND BEYOND

Wed	AI Safety Week, Day 3: Forecasting AI-Enabled Power Concentration Risk 11:15–12:15 · Design Exchange · you're approved
Wed	Hinton Lectures, night 3: governing transformative AI, then Geoffrey Hinton's Q&A 6:00–7:30 pm · livestream
Thu	Credit card payment your Todoist date
Sat	*Marches for an AI treaty* cities in the US, Canada and France · noted in Astral Codex Ten
Nov 16	Shivam's cohort: you're on food kosher meal needed · Todoist
Nov 23	Scaffolding Assignment 3 due Todoist

YOUR EVENTS (FROM LUMA)

Nov 10 Tue	**AI Safety Week, Day 2.** Three sessions at the Design Exchange, 11:15 to 4:45. APPROVED
Nov 9–11 6 pm	**The Hinton Lectures 2026.** Paul Christiano, three evenings. One livestream link works for all three. REGISTERED
Nov 11 Wed	**AI Safety Week, Day 3.** Power Concentration Risk, 11:15. APPROVED
Nov 6–8 you hosted	**Swarm Alignment Hackathon Toronto.** Done. Ilyass sent the slides to guests on Sunday. DONE

TAISI SLACK · SINCE SUNDAY

#taisi-team · money and plans

- Isabel reminded everyone to upload receipts to HCB. One missing receipt has locked Joseph's card. That hurts people who use the Uber Business account.
- Someone outside TAISI wants to run a linear algebra study group. Joseph would book a room and refer people, but not call it a TAISI program. Boyan agrees. Joseph offered to call the organizer first.

#taisi-team · running sessions

- Boyan asked that anyone helping run a session watch Discord for about 30 minutes after it starts, in case someone comes late.

#f26-facilitators

- Tazik shared the slides from Sunday's mech-interp talk.

#hackathons

- On Sunday, Pera said to hold off on ordering food. There were leftover subs from David's fellowship.

Quiet

- Nothing new in #general, #colloquium, #phl-panel, #reading-group, #writing-desk, #si-main, #si-notebooks or #off-topic.

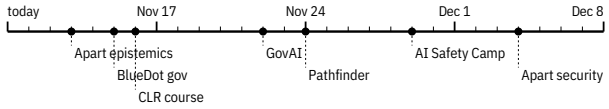
DON'T MISS

Opportunities

Sorted by deadline

Picked for a second-year CS and Public Policy student on TAISI's operations team. ★ = strong fit. Each item says why. Dates were checked on each program's own page on Nov 9.

THE NEXT FOUR WEEKS



CLOSING SOON

Nov 13
starts Fri

Apart: AI × Epistemics sprint Apart Research
A free online weekend sprint, Nov 13 to 15. Teams build a test, dataset or tool about how AI changes what people believe. $2,000 in prizes. Entries are due Sunday night.
This weekend. No AI safety background is needed, and you can work at your own pace. A low-cost way to get a first research write-up.
HACKATHON ONLINE FREE apartresearch.com/sprints

Nov 15
Sun

★ **Frontier AI Governance course (online)** BlueDot Impact

BlueDot's own free online governance course, about 40 hours. Take it as a six-day intensive or over six weeks. Groups run in many time zones.

The governance half of what you did at TAISI, with no travel. No earlier BlueDot course is required. You give your free hours after you apply.

COURSE ONLINE GOVERNANCE FREE **NEW** bluedot.org/courses/ai-governance

---

Nov 16
Mon, 23:59 GMT

★ **CLR Fundamentals Program** Center on Long-Term Risk

An online reading course, Nov 20 to Dec 21, on how advanced AI could cause suffering on a huge scale. About five hours a week. Meeting times fit the group.

Online, short, and new topics beyond what TAISI's fellowship covered. It runs into exam season, so five hours a week needs a plan.

COURSE ONLINE BEGINNER OK longtermrisk.org/intro-seminar

Nov 22
Sun, 23:59 UK time

★ **GovAI Summer Fellowship 2027 (London)** Centre for the Governance of AI

Three months of AI policy work in London, June 7 to Aug 27, 2027, paid £14,000. There is a research track and an applied track. No degree is required.

A stretch for a second-year, but CS plus policy is exactly their field. GovAI can sponsor UK work visas. Skip the DC version: it needs the right to work in the US.

FELLOWSHIP PAID GOVERNANCE STRETCH governance.ai/opportunities

---

Nov 24
Tue, 23:59 anywhere on Earth

★ **Kairos Pathfinder Fellowship, Spring 2027** Kairos

Mentoring, workshops and group funding for students who organize AI safety or AI policy groups at a university. Online. Decisions come Dec 2 and it starts Dec 5.

You help run TAISI, so you can apply. Each organizer applies alone. Kairos now funds only groups with an organizer in this program, so tell TAISI's leads. Undergrads get no personal stipend.

FIELD-BUILDING OPS REMOTE pathfinder.kairos-project.org

Nov 29
Sun; opens Nov 13

★ **AI Safety Camp 12** AI Safety Camp

An online research program, Jan 9 to Apr 18, 2027. You join a small team on a project picked in advance. The project list goes up Nov 13, when team applications open.

Part-time, remote and open to beginners. A good first research project, and it does not depend on SPAR. Read the list on Friday and apply to the governance or security projects.

RESEARCH REMOTE BEGINNER OK aisafety.camp

Dec 4
starts Fri

★ **Apart: Threat Intelligence & Threat Modelling hackathon** Apart Research

A free online weekend hackathon, Dec 4 to 6, run with Security Level 5. Teams test whether AI can speed up security planning for AI data centres. $5,000 in prizes.

The closest match to your security interest on this page. Entries are due Dec 6, 11:59pm anywhere on Earth. It falls near exams, so decide early.

HACKATHON SECURITY ONLINE FREE apartresearch.com

OPENING SOON: BEST FITS

Dec opens; date not announced

★ **SPAR, Spring 2027** SPAR (run by Kairos)
Remote, part-time research with a mentor, usually 5 to 20 hours a week. Open to undergrads. It has policy projects too. Applications open around December.
Your best next step: real research that fits around classes. Press "Express interest" on the site now so you get the email when it opens.
RESEARCH · REMOTE · UNDERGRAD OK · sparai.org

Dec 11 starts Fri

Apart: Agent Attribution Hackathon Apart Research
A free online weekend sprint, Dec 11 to 13, on telling rogue AI agents apart from ones a human is steering. Entries are due Dec 13.
An AI security topic close to your TryHackMe work. Some other sites still show Nov 27 to 29. Apart's own page says Dec 11.
HACKATHON · SECURITY · ONLINE · FREE · NEW · apartresearch.com

TBA not open yet

★ **Vector Institute research internship, summer 2027** Vector Institute
A paid research internship in Toronto, May to August, with a Vector professor. Vector takes summer applications from November to January. The page says they are closed for now.
In Toronto and open to undergrads at any school, in Canada or abroad. Letters are optional for undergrads. You need some machine learning experience.
RESEARCH · TORONTO · PAID · NEW · vectorinstitute.ai

TBA likely Feb; not announced

★ **UTSC summer research award (UTEA)** University of Toronto Scarborough
A $7,500 award to do 14 to 16 weeks of summer research with a UTSC professor. The 2027 date is not posted. The 2026 deadline was Feb 27.
On your own campus. Foreign students with a valid study permit for the summer can hold a UTEA. You need a professor to back you, so start asking in November.
RESEARCH · TORONTO · UNDERGRAD OK · PAID · NEW · utsc.utoronto.ca/research/utea-ursa

FOR TAISI, ANY TIME

any time

Money for TAISI projects always open
BlueDot Rapid Grants give up to $20,000 for AI safety projects. Manifund keeps a list of who else is funding. It says the Long-Term Future Fund has stopped taking new applications.
Useful for ops: hackathon food, room costs, compute keys. For TAISI's regular budget, the route is now the Pathfinder Fellowship above, due Nov 24.
GRANTS · FOR GROUPS · bluedot.org

A NOTE ON ACCURACY

Programs that don't fit you yet are listed in this morning's email. Always check dates on the program's own site.

NEWS

The World

The facts first. The opinions get labels.



REGION ONE

Indonesia

Old rights cases, a new deal for writers and artists, and a prize-winning chip.

INDONESIAN SCHOOLCHILDREN AND EXERCISE



Health Ministry free health check data, via ANTARA, Nov 9

RIGHTS

A new working group will try to move 13 stalled human rights cases

The government has set up a working group on past serious human rights cases. Coordinating Minister Yusril Ihza Mahendra announced it in Jakarta on Monday. Deputy Coordinating Minister Otto Hasibuan leads it.

Indonesia recognizes 17 such cases. Only four have gone to court. The other 13 are stuck between two bodies. The rights commission, Komnas HAM, does the first inquiry. The Attorney General's Office then investigates and prosecutes. Prosecutors keep sending files back, saying the evidence is not enough.

The stalled cases include the 1965–1966 anti-communist killings, the 1997–1998 forced disappearances and the May 1998 riots.

WHY IT MATTERS: *Families have waited decades for these cases to reach a court.*

ANTARA · Nov 9

CULTURE

The government wants authors paid when libraries lend their books

The government has proposed new rights for creators in a draft copyright law. Officials discussed it with parliament's lawmaking body in Jakarta on Monday. Hermansyah Siregar, the Director General of Intellectual Property, set out the ideas.

One idea is a public lending right. It would pay authors when libraries lend their works. Another is a resale right. It would give visual artists a share when certain works of art are sold again.

WHY IT MATTERS: *It could change how writers, artists and newsrooms in Indonesia earn money.*

ANTARA · Nov 10

HEALTH

Most Indonesian schoolchildren do not move enough, health checks show

The Health Ministry wants 80% of Indonesians to get enough physical activity by 2029. Spokesman Aji Muhawarman stated the goal on Monday.

The numbers for children are far from that. About 12.3 million school-age children had a free health check in 2025. Of those, 60.61% did not get enough physical activity. About 11.2 million had a fitness test. Of those, 73.42% had poor or very low fitness.

WHY IT MATTERS: *Active children are less likely to get diseases like high blood pressure later.*

ANTARA · Nov 9

STUDENTS

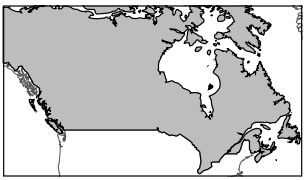
Bandung students win a national contest with a passport security chip

A student team from the Bandung Institute of Technology (ITB) won the PERURI Chip Hackathon 2026. The company PERURI held the contest and announced the result on Monday.

The team designed a security chip for electronic passports. It uses the tiny physical differences in each chip as a kind of fingerprint. That makes a chip harder to fake or copy.

WHY IT MATTERS: *Indonesia wants its own chip designers, and these students are a start.*

ANTARA · Nov 9



REGION TWO

Canada

Longer work permits, an old pandemic bill, and guns before the top court.

WORK

Employers can now keep low-wage foreign workers for two years

The federal government has doubled how long a business can employ a low-wage temporary foreign worker. The permit an employer needs now lasts up to two years, not one. Immigration Minister Lena Diab spoke about the changes on Monday in Stellarton, Nova Scotia.

> **Not everyone agrees.** Diab says many regions need the program, and that jobs should go to Canadians first. Conservative Leader Pierre Poilievre says it should be closed where unemployment is above 5.5%. The national rate was 6.7% in October.

WHY IT MATTERS: *It affects who gets hired for low-wage jobs across the country.*

The Canadian Press via CBC News · Nov 9

BUDGET

Ottawa gave up on collecting $4.5 billion in COVID benefits

The federal government wrote off $4.5 billion in COVID-19 benefits last fiscal year. A write-off means it no longer expects the money back. The

year before, the figure was $26 million. The numbers come from the Auditor General's review of the government's books.

The money was paid to people who got too much, or who did not qualify. Pandemic business loans are also at risk. The government expects to lose $5.6 billion of the $7.2 billion still owed.

WHY IT MATTERS: *Pandemic aid is still costing the government money.*

Global News · Nov 9

COURTS

The Supreme Court hears the challenge to the federal gun ban

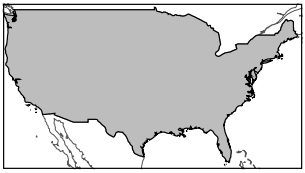
The Supreme Court of Canada began hearing arguments on Monday about a federal firearms ban. The hearing continues on Tuesday.

In May 2020, the government banned 1,500 models of firearm, including the AR-15. The list has since grown past 2,500. Two lower courts have upheld the ban, in 2023 and 2025.

> **Not everyone agrees.** The government says the guns are too deadly for civilian use, and thousands of other models remain legal. The Canadian Coalition for Firearm Rights says the courts never checked if people used the banned guns for hunting or sport.

WHY IT MATTERS: *The court will decide how far cabinet can go without a vote in Parliament.*

Global News · Nov 9



REGION THREE

United States

A court lets the border wall go on, and Democrats plan their next two years.

COURTS

The Supreme Court lets border wall work resume in Big Bend

The US Supreme Court ruled on Monday that border wall construction in west Texas can continue. A lawsuit against the project is still going on. A judge in El Paso had paused the work.

The plan covers hundreds of miles and includes Big Bend National Park. It calls for 30-foot steel barriers, patrol roads and surveillance systems. The court said the law lets the Homeland Security Secretary set aside environmental rules for border building.

The Big Bend sector is nearly 500 miles long. It regularly has the fewest border encounters in Texas, according to border agency data.

> **Not everyone agrees.** The government says a gap in Big Bend would draw cartels and illegal crossings. The Center for Biological Diversity says the work will damage canyon walls and untouched desert. NPR re-

ports that people in both parties oppose a wall there.

WHY IT MATTERS: *It tests how much nature law can be set aside for border security.*

NPR · Nov 9

SCHOOLS

Democrats plan to push back on Trump's education policy, with limited tools

Democrats will control both chambers of Congress from January. They plan to challenge President Trump's move to take apart the Education Department. Trump has promised to veto bills he sees as harmful.

Not everyone agrees. An Education Department spokesperson says Democrats want to "prematurely sabotage" Secretary Linda McMahon. Sen. Elizabeth Warren says the administration is "turning its back on students."

WHY IT MATTERS: *It shows what a new majority can and cannot do against a veto.*

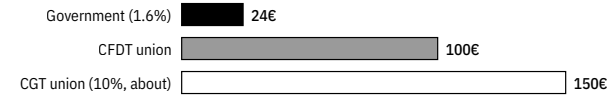
AP via PBS NewsHour · Nov 9

REGION FOUR

Around the World

A climate summit, a wage rise, a fallen bank, and two new gates in Cyprus.

FRANCE'S MINIMUM WAGE: THE OFFER AND THE DEMANDS



Al Jazeera, Nov 9

TURKEY

The UN climate summit opens in Turkey with a push for electricity

COP31, the UN's yearly climate meeting, opened on Monday in Antalya, Turkey. The host wants countries to sign a pledge called 35 by 35. It asks that electricity supply at least 35% of the world's energy by 2035. Today the share is about one-fifth, the International Energy Agency says. The pledge is non-binding, which means no one is forced to keep it.

Not everyone agrees. Turkey's environment minister, Murat Kurum, says electrification cuts emissions and protects countries from price shocks. Climate advocates say the pledge does not require the extra electricity to be low-carbon. Pacific island nations want a clear plan to leave fossil fuels. Saudi Arabia and other oil producers say fossil fuels can stay if emissions are captured.

WHY IT MATTERS: *The summit shapes how the world tries to slow warming during an energy crisis.*

Al Jazeera · Nov 9

FRANCE

France moves its minimum wage rise forward by a month

Prime Minister Sebastien Lecornu said on Monday the minimum wage will rise 1.6% on Dec 1. The rise was planned for January. Monthly pay goes from 1,477.93 euros to 1,502 euros, a gain of 24 euros.

The move follows weeks of student-led protests. They began over school funding and grew into protests about the cost of living. France votes for a new president in five months.

> **Not everyone agrees.** Lecornu calls it the second-largest rise in 20 years and "not merely symbolic". The CFDT, France's largest union, wants 100 euros more a month and calls the rise "insufficient". The CGT union wants 10%, about 150 euros, and calls it "crumbs".

WHY IT MATTERS: *It shows how a government responds to street protests before an election.*

Al Jazeera · Nov 9

PARAGUAY

A bank collapse in Paraguay brings down the president

Ueno Bank, a digital lender launched in 2021, collapsed last week. Nearly three million customers lost access to their savings. That is close to half the country. The Senate voted unanimously on Friday to remove President Santiago Pena. Police searched his home on Sunday.

Prosecutors say Pena pushed state bodies to deposit public money in the bank. He held shares in its parent company until March 2025. Ueno held about $850 million in public funds, including pension money. Pena denies wrongdoing.

> **Not everyone agrees.** Pena's lawyer says there is no evidence and that removing him hurts trust in the banks. Analyst Andrew Nickson of the University of Birmingham doubts that powerful politicians will face lasting punishment.

WHY IT MATTERS: *It shows the risk when a bank, its regulators and politicians are too close.*

Al Jazeera · Nov 9

CYPRUS

The two sides of Cyprus agree to open two new crossings

Cyprus has been split since 1974 into a Greek Cypriot south and a Turkish Cypriot north. On Monday the two leaders met a UN envoy in the buffer zone between them. They agreed to open two new crossings, coordinate emergency responses and share archives.

Local media say this brings the number of open crossings to 11. It is the first concrete step after nearly ten years of deadlock. The last official peace talks collapsed in 2017. The UN called the meeting "positive", and the leaders will meet again in the coming weeks.

WHY IT MATTERS: *Small, practical steps can rebuild trust before bigger peace talks.*

Al Jazeera · Nov 9

REGION FIVE

Science

A small dip in emissions, and what fiber did for mice.

CLIMATE

Fossil fuel emissions are set to dip slightly in 2026

Scientists project that carbon dioxide emissions from fossil fuels will fall 0.4% this year. From 2019 to 2025 they grew 0.8% a year on average. The study came out on Nov 9 in the journal Nature Climate Change.

The researchers say high oil prices from the Iran war probably caused the dip, not clean energy. Emissions should reach 38.24 gigatons, about 0.16 gigatons less than in 2025. A gigaton is a billion tons. Still, electric cars, solar and wind already help. Without them, emissions would have grown 1.9% a year since 2019.

WHY IT MATTERS: *A dip caused by a price shock may not last.*

Science News · Nov 9

HEALTH

Fiber helped mice clear tiny plastic bits from their guts

Researchers fed mice low, medium or high amounts of fiber, then gave them plastic particles. Within 24 hours, the medium and high fiber groups cleared more of the particles. After a week of daily plastic, only the low-fiber mice had gut damage. Test-tube work suggests fiber wraps around the particles and sticks to them.

This was a mouse study, published Oct 15 in Nature Communications. The high-fiber mice ate far more fiber than people are advised to eat. No one knows yet if the same thing happens in humans.

WHY IT MATTERS: *Tiny plastics are everywhere, and a common food may offer some protection.*

Science News · Nov 9

BUBBLE CHECK

Eight of the 14 newsletter emails that reached you in the last day were about AI. None of today's 16 news stories is. For a change of pace, read up on Cyprus. The island has been split for 52 years, and Monday brought its first real step in almost ten.

READ SLOWLY

The Essays

Printed whole, in the writers' own words

PERSUASION · NOV 9 · OPINION

The True Believer

by Damon Linker · Persuasion

A political writer argues that Trump's new chief of staff shows he will not soften after losing the midterms.

Democrats did so well in last Tuesday's midterm elections that for a few days afterwards it was possible to imagine we'd just lived through the end of the Trump era.

On social media and podcasts, pundits took note of the fact that the president appeared to accept the outcome without a fight. Could this mean he would be open to bipartisanship with the new and sizable Democratic majorities in Congress? Or perhaps that he would recede from governing altogether, allowing aides to run the show while he all but retired to the White House? Or might it even be possible he would resign the presidency, allowing Vice President JD Vance to take over and the country as a whole to move on from the anxiety and dramas of the past decade?

Such musings were nice while they lasted—but they didn't last long. The fantasies came to an abrupt end on Friday, when the president announced on Truth Social that White House Chief of Staff Susie Wiles would be stepping down to be replaced by Stephen Miller.

Miller served as a senior advisor to the president in the first Trump administration, with special focus on immigration policy. Since the start of the second administration, he has been Homeland Security Advisor and White House Deputy Chief of Staff for Policy. But this rundown of Miller's resume fails to capture what is most distinctive about him. Miller is a true-believing MAGA ideologue, a fiercely committed Trump loyalist, someone convinced Judeo-Christian white civilization is fatally threatened with a "great replacement" by people from other races and religions, and a man who longs to see the president assert and wield unconstrained power.

Far from signaling the conclusion of the Trump era, the midterm elections of 2026 now look likely to be viewed as the moment when the country began to confront an even more intense challenge to liberal democratic principles from the hardline xenophobic right than the one we've already been enduring for much of the past 10 years.

Respect vs. Contempt for Public Opinion

When Bill Clinton, George W. Bush, and Barack Obama saw their parties' congressional majorities swept away by midterm discontent, they were chastened. Their embrace of greater moderation after electoral rebukes flowed partly from an acceptance of political reality: With Congress lost, governing required the trimming of sails and a willingness to compromise with ideological opponents.

But there was more to it than this. Politicians in a democracy typically defer to and respect public opinion, even when they disagree with it. Just as a solid electoral victory bestows a sense of democratic legitimacy on a governing agenda, a drubbing does the reverse. It conveys vital information about how the American people are responding to that agenda. When the response is sufficiently negative, the former sense of legitimacy diminishes or vanishes altogether, leaving a president and his party weakened.

Though only if the president is open to receiving the message.

Trump's decision to promote Miller to the position of White House Chief of Staff is an undeniable sign that the president has no intention whatsoever of deferring to the message of displeasure the midterm elections conveyed. On the contrary, the president appears eager to defy that message. Rather than feeling chastened, Trump seems committed to moving further away from anything resembling moderation and compromise. Whereas the election showed that many more Americans disapprove of how Trump is governing the country than support it, the president thinks the right response is to double down on a maximally MAGA agenda.

The Politics of Hyperbole

Miller is passionately devoted to the cause of doing exactly that. In addition to strongly supporting Trump's protectionist tariff agenda and the vaccine skepticism of Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., he is an unapologetic anti-immigration zealot. Miller wants ICE and the Border Patrol to deport as many people as possible as quickly as possible, without regard for the effect this will have on immigrant communities, families, and children, or for whether the immigrants have committed any crime since arriving in the country. (Miller was the primary advocate behind the highly unpopular policy of family separation that generated considerable controversy and was eventually abandoned during the first Trump administration.)

This makes Miller an extremist on the issue. But it's not merely his goals that are radical. It's also the means he believes should be employed to achieve his preferred ends. When an ICE agent killed anti-ICE protester Renee Good in Minneapolis last winter, Miller immediately labeled her,

without evidence, a "domestic terrorist," just as he described protester Alex Pretti, a nurse shot to death in the same city 17 days later by two federal immigration agents, as a "would-be assassin."

These hyperbolic lies were not exceptions for Miller. They were expressions of a worldview rooted in panic and alarm about the existential threat immigration and its defenders pose to the American way of life. The threat is so acute that Miller has long advocated suspending habeas corpus (the requirement that government officials must legally justify detaining a person) for noncitizens, despite its presence in Article I of the Constitution. The rule has been suspended four times in American history, each time in conformity with the constitutional stipulation that a suspension can only be put into effect in times of rebellion or invasion.

That's why Miller consistently calls, and urges the president to call, immigration a form of "invasion" that is leading the country to being "conquered"—that is, in order to lay the legal groundwork for such a move. (Miller has also called birthright citizenship "a deep knife wound in the heart of the American republic" that will produce the "suicide" of our "civilization," and has denied the Democrats are even a party, preferring to call them "a domestic extremist organization.") As Maggie Haberman and Jonathan Swan of The New York Times reported, others in the administration have actively opposed Miller's efforts in this area, though with Miller set to run the White House, such opposition will now likely be neutered.

Emergency Situations

Miller (along with Vance) has likewise been a leading advocate of Trump invoking the Insurrection Act against those protesting deportation sweeps. Doing so would give the president exceptionally broad powers to deploy military forces on American soil. As with the suspension of habeas corpus, Miller favors Trump asserting these powers in order to test the limits of what the system will permit the president to do in emergency situations.

The emphasis on emergency is key. Political philosophers as different from one another as Aristotle, John Locke, and Carl Schmitt have recognized that legal norms, and even the rule of law itself, can be justly set aside in emergency situations in which the very survival of the polity is at stake. The question then becomes: What constitutes a genuine emergency or situation of existential threat? The answer can ultimately be determined only by elected officials, judges, and citizens exercising independent judgment.

That points to an exceedingly dangerous possibility. What if someone in power continually describes the status quo as a situation involving a dire threat—or even behaves in such a way as to provoke the very chaotic conditions that would justify their own seizure of post-constitutional rule? The

first option (threat inflation) is something Miller, along with the president and countless right-wing "influencers," regularly engages in. Meanwhile, the second (acting to cause the very crisis that justifies an extralegal seizure of power) is what Miller seems to have been hoping for last winter in Minnesota.

In the end, cooler heads in the White House prevailed, leading ICE to back off its highly aggressive actions in the state.

Testing the Outer Limits of Presidential Power

Who were those cooler heads? We have reason to suspect that one of them may have been outgoing Chief of Staff Susie Wiles. According to the reporting by Haberman and Swan, the push to suspend habeas corpus for noncitizens was abandoned after an "archconservative" White House lawyer named Will Scharf wrote a confidential memo to Wiles making the case against any such move. Did Scharf write the memo unbidden? Or, more likely, did Wiles ask him to put his misgivings down on paper in order to provide herself with legal justification for quashing the power grab?

Regardless of what happened behind the scenes, it's clear where Miller was eager to go—and equally clear that he has now been elevated to a position within the administration that will enable him to make the crucial judgment calls about what the nation's ongoing immigration "emergency" requires with regard to habeas corpus and the Insurrection Act. He will be making these calls with no oversight at all, besides the minimal and mercurial one provided by the man who just promoted him.

We should be very grateful that the president and his fanatical enabler will be facing broad Democratic majorities in both houses of Congress come January 3, 2027. But we shouldn't downplay the threat that they nonetheless pose to the competent and lawful functioning of democracy in the United States over the next two years. Those in charge of the executive branch may well actively seek to precipitate a constitutional crisis in the hope of testing the outer limits of presidential power.

That's a situation no American should hope for—though it is one all of us need to be prepared for.

■

persuasion.community/p/the-true-believer · Damon Linker teaches political science at the University of Pennsylvania

IN PLAIN WORDS, AND THE OTHER SIDE

The short version: Democrats won the midterms on Nov 3. Some people hoped Trump would now move to the middle, as Clinton, Bush and Obama did after losing. Instead, on Friday he made Stephen Miller his chief of staff.

That is the person who runs the White House day to day. Linker says Miller wants the hardest line on immigration. He has pushed to suspend habeas corpus for non-citizens. Habeas corpus is the rule that the government must justify locking someone up. He has also pushed to use the Insurrection Act, a law that lets a president send soldiers into American cities. Linker's fear is a leader who keeps calling things an "emergency" so he can step around the normal rules.

The other side. This is opinion, from a magazine that openly opposes Trump. Words like "zealot" and "fanatical" are the writer's judgement, not facts. Miller's supporters would say he is carrying out the immigration policy Trump campaigned on and won with in 2024. Two things here are guesses. That Susie Wiles blocked the habeas plan is, in Linker's own words, something "we have reason to suspect". And the constitutional crisis is a forecast, not an event. Courts and a Democratic Congress will also have a say from January.

CHINAI #381 · NOV 9

China's Venture Capital Market Is Defying Common Sense

by Jeffrey Ding (translating Liu Xiaoqing) · ChinAI Newsletter

A Chinese analyst lists five ways money for new tech companies has gone wrong.

Context: Liu Xiaoqing is director of analysis at IT Juzi, one of my favorite sources on China's venture capital ecosystem. Last week, she posted a lengthy denunciation that begins with this bold statement:

> *In 2026, a year where "embodied AI" has become practically in unison with "Chinese venture capital," there are too many things happening that run counter to common sense.*

Let's break down Liu's critique into five main parts.

1. Inflated valuations based on résumés alone

Big tech execs and elite university PhD graduates easily land initial valuations of hundreds of millions of RMB. Liu critiques the restless, rushed mindset of these young geniuses, who spin and chase narratives defined by fundraising windows — unmoored from technological progress and maturity.

2. All-star lineups that don't form real teams

Liu has seen countless founding teams that look good on paper: "a brilliant technical lead, a former executive from a major tech firm, a supply-chain veteran, and someone well-versed in the world of capital." In prac-

tice, the whole is much less than the sum of its parts. In a piece full of zingers, this might have been my favorite one:

> *Yet, for many teams today, the journey looks more like this: the first time you meet happens at a dinner arranged by a financial advisor, the second time you meet takes place at the negotiating table for a term sheet, and the third you meet is the signing ceremony. People with completely different backgrounds, splitting equity 40/30/30, suddenly find themselves "running a company together" from day one. That's not called a partnership; that's called assembling a party for a video game quest.*

That's not called a partnership; that's called assembling a party for a video game quest.

3. Startups that look like tech giants from day one

Liu recalls learning about an embodied AI startup founded in 2023. Its founding experience reflects how the VC market is skipping steps when it comes to cultivating organizational capital:

> *They had raised hundreds of millions in their Series A round. Their office was in a high-rise building, complete with a logo wall at the reception. They had hired an HR director poached from a major tech giant, who spent the very first month setting up a rigid corporate hierarchy and performance review system. The founder, in his early thirties, had previously launched a startup out of a residential apartment, where four people shared a single case of instant noodles and spent three days haggling with a cloud service provider just to save on server costs. Only five years separate these two experiences. Yet, throughout those five years, he never truly experienced the process of an organization growing from five people to five hundred. But in this second venture, his team started out with five hundred people from the start.*

4. Dependence on government-backed funds

Liu writes, "And here's the most terrifying, yet often overlooked, aspect: a massive portion of this capital comes from state-backed funds." Government guidance funds often involve an initial seed fund contributed by the government, with the remaining majority raised from local state-owned enterprises, private capital, and bank partners. However, as Liu notes, "When private capital enters a government guidance fund, it often comes with strings attached, such as requirements for 're-investment' (investing a portion of the capital back into the local area), specific policy objectives, and various constraints that prioritize goals other than pure financial return."

Liu's piece contains this sobering quote: "Yet, even among the most professional and long-established funds, those that have been around for only seven or eight years, the number that have truly completed the full lifecycle of 'fundraising, investment, management, and exit' can be counted on one's fingers." Again, the big question is what happens when these funds reach maturity (typical funds have a lifespan of 7–10 years)? Liu shares more stories: "I have encountered instances where, by the time a fund reached maturity, not a single project had exited. In the end, the only solution was for a local state-owned enterprise (SOE) to step in and take over the assets."

5. A fragile system

Putting all of these points together, Liu's thesis is that China's VC ecosystem is far too fragile. She outlines this un-virtuous circle: "Capital flows in too quickly, forcing young founders to chase ever-higher valuations; the pace of growth outstrips the organization's ability to mature… by the time these valuations are reached, no clear path for an exit has been established; with no exit in sight, the pressure ultimately falls back on the founders."

She ends with a comparison to a previous wave of mass entrepreneurship in the mid-2010s, when there was a boom of e-commerce and internet startups. There were also absurd valuations in that wave, but the chaotic mix was resilient because the ecosystem had a tolerance for failure. Liu points out, "Consequently, while that previous wave saw a massive number of casualties, the deaths were 'clean' — leaving the soil, in fact, even more fertile." In contrast, the current Chinese entrepreneurship wave is lacking time and tolerance for failure.

■

chinai.substack.com/p/chinai-381-chinas-venture-capital · full translation linked there

WHY IT'S HERE

It is a view from inside China, translated, about how new companies get money. Like Noah Smith in the Newsstand, it says China's state-led investing has gone too far. Liu Xiaoqing is one analyst with one view. Others in China would defend the state's role.

YOUR INBOX

The Newsstand

The last 24 hours, summed up

NOAHPINION · Noah Smith

SUMMARY

Why I'm becoming a China bear

Opinion, from Saturday. Noah Smith long expected China to keep rising. Now he doubts it. China's plan to make everything is running into a wall, he says: its own shoppers are spending less, export markets are filling up, and factory profits are falling. The free part of the post stops before his main reason, which is AI.

AI FUTURES PROJECT

SUMMARY

Verified compute allocation disclosures as a foundational governance tool

A policy proposal, and close to your interest in technical AI governance. "Compute" means the computer chips an AI company runs. The authors want AI companies to report regularly how they use their compute: how much goes to building stronger AI, how much to safety research, and how much to serving customers. Outside auditors would check the reports. They call this VCAD.

Why bother? The authors want companies to slow down the building of more powerful AI. They call that "pacing". Almost every way of slowing down, they argue, needs someone to check that no hidden chips are doing banned work. They also say it is not enough to delay big training runs. If research carries on, the progress piles up and arrives all at once later. Public reports could let people compare companies and reward the careful ones.

Keep in mind: the authors rate their own confidence as "medium". The group behind the post wants AI development slowed, so it starts from that goal. The post does not say how auditors would catch hidden chips, or why companies would agree to be checked.

ASTRAL CODEX TEN

BLURB

Open Thread 459

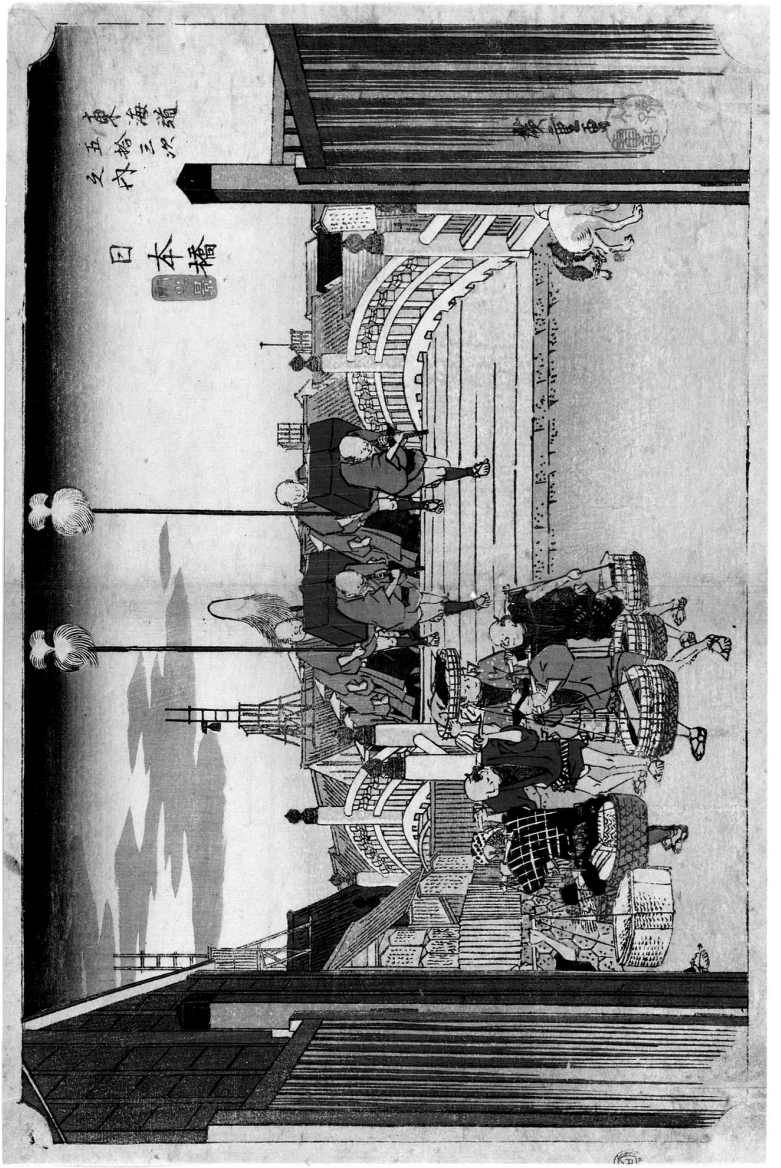
Two notes. An astronomer wrote in to say it is untrue that there are millions of "Wow" signals. And marches for an AI treaty are planned for Saturday, Nov 14, in cities across the US, Canada and France.

VISUAL CAPITALIST

BLURB

The world's biggest economies vs. debt in 2026

A chart, not an essay. The US has the largest economy. Sudan owes the most compared with the size of its economy.



THE ROAD · STOP 1 OF 55

Nihonbashi: Morning View · Hiroshige, c. 1834

Every trip on the Tōkaidō, the great road from Edo (now Tokyo) to Kyoto, started at this bridge. Here a lord's parade crosses at dawn while fish sellers wait to get by. Hiroshige made 55 prints of the road. Turn the page sideways to see it the right way up.

Public domain. Cooper Hewitt, Smithsonian Design Museum, via Wikimedia Commons.